



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 11

PART 1

You will hear a telephone conversation between a volunteer coordinator named Sarah and an applicant named James. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker A: Hello, Greenwood Conservation Group. How can I help you today?

Speaker B: Hi, I'd like to sign up as a volunteer. My friend told me about your weekend restoration projects.

Speaker A: That's wonderful! I can take your details now to get you registered. What is your full name?

Speaker B: It's James Garrard.

Speaker A: Could you spell your surname for me, please?

Speaker B: Yes, it's G-A-R-R-A-R-D.

Speaker A: Got it. And what is a good contact phone number for you?

Speaker B: Yes, it's 0-7-9-1-1-5-5-2-3-8-4.

Speaker A: Let me read that back: 0-7-9-1-1-5-5-2-3-8-4. Is that correct?

Speaker B: Yes, that's it.

Speaker A: Excellent. We have a few different volunteer sectors. Which area of interest do you prefer? We have wildlife monitoring, trail maintenance, and tree planting.

Speaker B: I'd love to do some planting. I enjoy gardening and want to do something practical.

Speaker A: Perfect. We have sessions on weekends. Are you available on Saturdays or Sundays?

Speaker B: Saturdays are usually best for me... hold on, actually, I forgot I have a morning class on Saturdays starting next month, so Sunday would be much better. Let's make it Sunday.

Speaker A: Sunday it is. Now, for your first session, we're working at a brand new site. It's not our usual parkland, we are focusing on the riverbank this week.

Speaker B: The riverbank, okay. Should I bring any specific equipment?



Speaker A: We provide spades and bags, but all volunteers must bring their own gloves for safety.

Speaker B: Okay, I'll make sure to pack some strong gloves.

Speaker A: If you're a member of our partner organization, the National Trust, there is no fee, otherwise it's five pounds.

Speaker B: Oh, I am a member. My membership number is 4-8-2-9-1... wait, sorry, let me check that card again... no, I need to correct that, it is 4-8-2-9-7.

Speaker A: Thanks, I've got 4-8-2-9-7. That means your registration fee today is zero.

Speaker B: Wonderful. Where do we meet on Sunday?

Speaker A: We meet at the bridge just past the main entrance. You can park there too.

Speaker B: Great, at the bridge. And what is the date of this Sunday's session?

Speaker A: It will be on the fourteenth of October.

Speaker B: Got it, October fourteenth. Thanks for your help!

Speaker A: You're welcome. See you there!

This is the end of Part 1.



PART 2

You will hear a local council officer named David giving a presentation about the reopening of the Redwood Community Library. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening everyone, and thank you for coming to our community presentation. I am delighted to announce that the Redwood Community Library is finally ready to reopen its doors to the public after a six-month closure. The main reason we closed our doors in January wasn't actually to expand the physical space as we initially hoped, nor to repair the roof, which is still scheduled for next year. Instead, we needed to upgrade our entire IT infrastructure and install state-of-the-art self-service terminals. Moving on to the children's section, you'll find we've shifted it to the back of the library to keep it quieter for other users. We haven't managed to get rare comics yet, but we are proud to introduce a beautifully decorated storytelling area with soft seating. Our new private study rooms are also extremely popular. While visitors must book these in advance online, they are completely free of charge to anyone who holds a valid library membership. Non-members, including visiting students, must pay a small hourly fee. To celebrate our reopening this Friday, we have planned some special events. We originally invited a local author to speak, but unfortunately, she had to cancel. Instead, local artists have kindly set up an exhibition of their paintings in the gallery, which you can browse all day. We also hoped to hand out free books, but due to budget constraints, we'll only be offering bookmarks. If you'd like to support us, we are looking for volunteers to help with shelving and events. To apply, you should attend the information session scheduled for next Tuesday evening, rather than trying to apply online or asking the head librarian on a busy afternoon. Now, let me review some of our updated guidelines. Under our new system, each member is allowed to borrow a maximum of eight books at any one time. You can keep them for up to three weeks before they must be renewed. To use the public computers, you need to reserve a slot. You can do this easily through our official website. Although we don't have a full café, we have installed a modern vending machine in the lobby where you can buy high-quality hot coffee and tea. We have also upgraded our network, so visitors can now access high-speed wifi anywhere in the building.

This is the end of Part 2.

PART 3

You will hear two university students, Chloe and Hannah, discussing their research project with their tutor, Professor Helen Green. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker A: Thank you for meeting with us today, Professor Green. We've compiled our initial research on urban green spaces.

Speaker C: It's a pleasure. Tell me, what did you both find most surprising during your initial research phase?

Speaker A: We were amazed by how much people actually care about these spaces. We expected general apathy, but the public response to our survey was massive.

Speaker B: Yes, and while there were plenty of existing studies, and we knew city center wildlife was quite scarce, the sheer enthusiasm of local residents was totally unexpected.

Speaker C: Interesting. And why did you limit your study to public parks and exclude residential gardens?

Speaker B: We initially thought about including them, but getting permission from homeowners to map their private gardens proved to be a logistical nightmare.

Speaker A: Yes, even though their sizes are highly variable, which would have been an interesting factor, and previous researchers haven't really done much on them, the access issue was the real dealbreaker.

Speaker C: I see. Now, looking at your online survey methodology, I have one major concern. It's not the size of your sample, which is actually very robust, and your questions are beautifully neutral. However, because you only distributed it via social media, you're likely to get responses primarily from younger people, which means your data won't represent the entire local population.

Speaker B: That makes sense. We should probably supplement it with some paper surveys in the parks.

Speaker A: Definitely. For the physical environment, we're also planning to analyze soil quality.

Speaker B: We want to be scientific, so instead of just picking random spots or hiring a technician which we can't afford, we've divided each park into a grid on our map and will take a sample from the center of each square.

Speaker C: Sounds systematic. And what will be the primary focus of the presentation you're delivering next month?

Speaker A: Although we collected great data comparing our city to others, and we have ideas on heat islands, our main goal is to showcase the detailed map we've created that highlights the corridors wildlife use to travel between parks.

Speaker C: Let's discuss who is doing what for the remaining tasks. Who is going to write the literature review?

Speaker A: Hannah has already read most of the papers, so she's agreed to take full responsibility for writing that section.

Speaker C: Excellent. And what about processing the survey data with the new analysis software?

Speaker B: Chloe is much better at statistics than I am, but we decided we should both sit down and do the software analysis together so we both understand the output.

Speaker C: Good idea. Who will be interviewing the park rangers?

Speaker A: I've already set up the meetings and will be doing those interviews solo, as Hannah will be busy with the lab work then.

Speaker C: Perfect. What about preparing the presentation slides?

Speaker B: I enjoy graphic design, so I'll handle making the slides look professional.

Speaker C: Excellent. And the final report?

Speaker A: We feel strongly that a co-authored paper is best, so we will both write the final report together, combining our sections.

Speaker C: Sounds like a solid plan.

This is the end of Part 3.

PART 4

You will hear an academic lecture by Dr. Eleanor Vance on the history and science of silk production. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Good morning, everyone. Today, we will explore the fascinating history and science of sericulture, which is the commercial cultivation of silkworms for the production of silk. According to ancient Chinese legend, silk was discovered around 2700 BC. For centuries, its production was a closely guarded secret, and the luxury fabric was exclusively reserved for the use of the royal family. Eventually, the secret leaked, and the famous Silk Road emerged, facilitating trade across Asia and allowing this precious textile to reach the Roman Empire, where it became a symbol of extreme wealth. A turning point occurred in the 6th century when Byzantine Emperor Justinian sent monks to smuggle silkworm eggs out of China. They successfully hid the eggs inside hollow bamboo walking sticks, introducing silk production to the Western world. Now, let us look at the biological process. The biological process of sericulture relies on the domestic silk moth, *Bombyx mori*. These moths have been domesticated to the point where they cannot survive in the wild. Their larvae have an incredibly specific diet, feeding exclusively on the leaves of the mulberry tree. As the larvae feed, they grow rapidly and must shed their tight outer skin multiple times. This process, known as molting, occurs four times before they are ready to spin their cocoons. To create the cocoon, the silkworm secretes a continuous liquid thread from its specialized salivary glands, which solidifies upon contact with the air. To harvest the silk, the cocoons must be processed before the moths hatch and damage the fibers. This is done by placing them in hot water, which dissolves the sticky protein holding the cocoon together and allows the single thread to be carefully unwound. Beyond fashion, modern science has found remarkable new uses for silk. Because of its incredible tensile strength and biocompatibility, medical researchers are currently using silk fibers to manufacture artificial tendons and ligaments. In addition, the cosmetics industry has embraced silk. Hydrolyzed silk proteins are now widely incorporated into premium skin creams and hair products to retain moisture and improve texture. Finally, materials scientists are exploring genetic modifications to create 'smart' silk. By altering the silkworm's diet or genetics, they hope to produce silk that can conduct electricity, opening up possibilities for wearable electronics.

This is the end of Part 4.